



“I FIRMLY BELIEVE IN BEING THE LOWEST-COST PRODUCER, THE LAST MAN STANDING”

Aditya Birla Group Chairman Kumar Mangalam Birla on reimagining business models, global plans, focus on sustainability, and more

46 | In an exclusive interview to *Krishna Gopalan*, Aditya Birla Group Chairman **KUMAR MANGALAM BIRLA** shares what made him enter two new sectors—paints and jewellery—and why India, along with the US, will remain central to the group’s future initiatives. Edited excerpts:



Over the past three-five years, how have you approached the decision-making process for entering new businesses? What parameters have gained greater importance in this context?

A business group with a legacy as enduring as ours thrives by embracing a growth mindset—continuously and thoughtfully

expanding into new sectors with a clear focus on scale, long-term value, and strategic alignment with emerging opportunities. Our approach is rooted in market leadership—being among the top three players—and ability to create impact. Every step we take is driven by the aspirations of a resurgent India, home to the world’s largest young population.

Over the last few years, we have redoubled our bet on the dynamism of the Indian consumer by launching two major consumer brands—in paints and jewellery. The Indian consumer is evolving rapidly and becoming one of the most promising cohorts globally. We are well-positioned to tap into this growth given

the innate power and strength of the Aditya Birla brand. Our ability to leverage synergies across businesses also plays a key role in this. For example, our robust cement distribution network has enabled an entry into the paints sector. Likewise, our deep experience in fashion, design, retail, and lifestyle, honed over 20-plus years, equips us to understand consumer trends and occasions—insights that are crucial for driving success in the jewellery market.

With our strategic bets, we are not only expanding in size but also diversifying in scope. By blending the strength of our established businesses with the fresh energy of our new ventures, we are creating a unique growth platform.



Several legacy businesses within the AV Birla Group—such as cement and aluminium—have successfully adapted to changing market dynamics. How have you disrupted the status quo to make them even more resilient and future-ready?

Our strategy for making legacy businesses like cement, metals, fibre, and chemicals future-ready is anchored in four core pillars—scale, sustainability, customer-centricity, and continuous innovation.

Scale remains a defining advantage. Consider UltraTech Cement: it took 36 years to reach 100 MTPA capacity, but just five years to grow